

Becoming a Microsoft MVP is a great goal. Below is a practical, step-by-step plan you can follow, with a 6\12\24 month timeline, concrete actions you can do weekly/monthly, measurable targets, a nomination checklist, a short nomination template you can adapt.

Quick summary

Becoming an MVP means becoming a visible, consistent community leader in a Microsoft technology area by producing high-quality, helpful technical contributions (blog posts, talks, OSS, forum answers, meetups, docs, sample code). Do that consistently for ~12–24 months, get nominated (anyone can nominate you, including self-nomination), and the MVP review team evaluates technical expertise + community impact.

Step-by-step plan (practical)

1) Pick your focus (week 1)

- Choose 1–2 Microsoft technology areas (example: Azure Data, Azure Infrastructure, .NET, Power Platform, Microsoft 365, DevOps, Security).
- Narrowing helps build authority faster.

2) Learn to expert level (weeks 1–12)

- Build deep, current knowledge: docs, certification study paths, hands-on labs.
- Create at least 2 significant learning artifacts (sample project + writeup).
- Target: be able to solve intermediate→advanced community questions.

3) Start contributing publicly (months 1–6) — daily/weekly actions

Weekly habits (examples):

- Answer at least 3 community questions (Stack Overflow, Microsoft Q&A, GitHub issues).
- Publish 1 micro-article or demo (blog post, LinkedIn post, or short video).
- Share a short how-to or snippet on Twitter/X or LinkedIn.

Monthly habits:

- Publish 1 long blog post or 1 recorded demo (10–20 minutes).
- Open-source one useful script/sample or contribute a PR to an existing repo.
- Run or co-host 1 community session (local meetup, user group, online).

Targets for months 1–6:

- 12+ quality answers across forums.
- 6 micro posts + 2 longer posts.
- 1 public repo or 3 useful Gists/snippets.

4) Amplify & present (months 4–12)

- Apply to speak at local meetups/user groups (start small). Target: 3–6 talks/year.
- Create slide decks and upload to SlideShare / Docs / GitHub.
- Record short YouTube demos or stream labs.
- Volunteer as mentor in community programs.

Targets for months 6–12:

- 3–6 talks (meetup or virtual).
- 1 conference submission (regional) — even if not accepted, submit and iterate.
- 2–3 medium/long technical blog posts.

5) Build sustained impact (months 9–18)

- Maintain and grow an open-source project or collection of reusable samples.
- Create a reproducible tutorial/workshop materials used by others.
- Be an active moderator/regular contributor on Microsoft Q&A or other official channels.
- Organize a workshop or community event (virtual or in person).

Measurable impact examples:

- GitHub repo with documentation + issues activity and contributors.
- Blog posts with sustained views / shares.
- Repeated speaking invitations.

6) Network & get visible (ongoing)

- Connect with existing MVPs on Twitter/LinkedIn, attend community events, ask for feedback.
- Ask for references — you'll need nominators (other MVPs or community leaders are ideal).

7) Nomination (after ~12–18 months of consistent impact)

- Anyone can nominate you (including self-nomination).
- Gather evidence: links to blog posts, talks (videos/slides), GitHub repos/PRs, forum posts/answers, event pages, attendee feedback.
- Submit nomination via the Microsoft MVP nomination form (available on Microsoft's site) or ask a nominator to submit on your behalf.
- If you self-nominate, include at least 10–20 strong links and short context for each.

8) If nominated: follow up (weeks after nomination)

- Microsoft sometimes requests clarifications — be responsive.
- Continue contributing (MVP selection considers recent activity).

9) Maintain & renew (after awarded)

- MVP award is annual; maintain contributions and community leadership to be renewed.

Concrete weekly & monthly checklist (copyable)**Weekly:**

- Answer 3 community questions (link each).
- Post 1 short technical update/article/snippet.
- Spend 4–8 hours improving a sample project or preparing talk materials.

Monthly:

- Publish 1 long tutorial or recorded demo.
- Contribute 1 PR or issue to OSS.
- Apply/submit to one speaking opportunity.

Quarterly:

- Host or co-host a meetup/workshop.
- Review and compile top contribution links into a single doc for nomination.

Measurable targets (12 months example)

- Forum answers: 100+ (mix of short + detailed).
- Blog posts: 12 (monthly) + 6 medium/long tutorials.
- Talks: 4 (meetups) + 1 conference submission.
- OSS: maintain 1 project or 10 meaningful PRs.
- Social: 500–2000 followers across platforms (not required but helps visibility).

Things that matter most to MVP reviewers

- Technical depth and accuracy.
- Original content that helps many people (tutorials, sample code, tools).
- Consistency and sustained community leadership, not one-off activity.
- Evidence of influence (people using your code, attendees at your sessions, citations).
- Community focus — helping and enabling other people, not self promotion only.

Common pitfalls & what to avoid

- Low-quality or duplicated content (thin blog posts).
- Only internal/closed contributions — MVPs need public impact.
- Posting the same content repeatedly without added value.
- Overemphasizing follower count over measurable help (answers, stars, downloads, event attendance).

Nomination checklist (what to prepare)

1. Short bio (2–3 lines) and professional profile links (LinkedIn/GitHub).
2. Focus area(s) (e.g., Azure AI, .NET, Power Platform).
3. Top 10 links with short descriptions (blog posts, talks with date & audience size, GitHub repos/PRs, forum answers with links).
4. Evidence of impact (stars, downloads, attendees, citations).
5. Names of 1–3 nominators (if you have them) or note self-nomination.
6. Any awards/recognitions (optional).

Sample nomination paragraph (short template)

I nominate **[Your Name]** for the Microsoft MVP award in **[focus area]**. Over the past 12–18 months [Your Name] has regularly published in-depth tutorials and production-ready sample code, answered hundreds of community questions, and delivered X technical talks (links below). Highlights: created and maintains the **[repo name]** (Y stars, Z downloads), wrote a 3-part Azure tutorial series used by multiple teams, and organized monthly community workshops with average attendance of N developers. Links: [list of 8–12 most important links with one-line descriptions].

(Replace bracketed sections with your specifics.)

Fast start plan you can start today (first 30 days)

1. Pick your technology focus and create a one-page plan.
2. Create a public GitHub repo named yourname-[topic]-samples.
3. Write and publish one helpful tutorial (600–1500 words) and share it on LinkedIn/Twitter.
4. Answer 5 questions on Microsoft Q&A or Stack Overflow with full, actionable answers.
5. Apply to speak at one local meetup — prepare a short 30-minute talk outline.

6-month MVP roadmap, nomination draft, and custom checklist:

✓ Step 1 — Need These Inputs:

Please paste the following information:

A) Your Technical Focus Area(s)

Choose 1–2 Microsoft areas you want to be known for. For example:

- Azure SQL / SQL Server
- Azure Data Engineering
- Azure Infrastructure
- Power BI / Power Platform
- .NET Developer Platform
- Azure DevOps / GitHub
- Security
- AI / Azure OpenAI
- M365 / SharePoint / Teams

(You can write your own — doesn't need to match exactly.)

Please fill:

My MVP focus area(s): _____

B) Your Public Contributions (paste links + short notes)

Need ~6–12 good links. Examples:

- Blog posts
- LinkedIn technical posts
- GitHub repos / scripts / tools
- YouTube demo videos
- Talks (slides or event page)
- StackOverflow / Microsoft Q&A answers
- Medium articles
- Meetup sessions you hosted

Please fill:

Paste links like this:

1. https://... — blog post — topic, date
2. https://... — GitHub repo — what it does
3. https://... — LinkedIn post — topic
4. https://... — YouTube — demo on XYZ

C) Your Short Profile

This is used for nomination draft.

Please fill:

- Your name:
- Job role / title:
- Country:
- 1–2 lines about what you do (ex: "SQL Server DBA focusing on migrations to Azure SQL")

Below is a **fully generated MVP package**—a 6-month roadmap, a nomination draft, and a Google-Sheet-ready checklist. Everything is **personalized for you (Kumar, SQL Server DBA | India)** with focus areas:

- **Azure SQL / SQL Server Database Administration**
- **Azure Data Engineering**
- **Azure Infrastructure**
- Experience: **Migrations to Azure SQL & AWS RDS/EC2**



1. Personalized 6-Month MVP Roadmap



Monthly Goals (Month-by-Month Plan)

Month 1 – Brand Foundation & Visibility

- Build/refine LinkedIn + GitHub profile
- Start weekly technical posts
- Publish 1 long blog on **SQL Server → Azure SQL migration best practices**
- Join 2 Azure communities (local + global)
- Record one short video intro on Azure SQL features

Month 2 – Technical Depth & Tutorials

- Publish a 3-part blog series on **Azure SQL Performance Optimization**
- Start a **bi-weekly SQL migration tips** series
- Host one live session (YouTube/LinkedIn)
- Begin contributions to GitHub sample repos
- Attend Azure UG sessions & share learnings

Month 3 – Community Speaking & Open-Source

- Deliver at least **2 user group sessions** (SQL/Azure)
- Release a GitHub toolkit:
Azure Migration Scripts Pack
- Publish 1 case study from your experience
- Collaborate with MVPs for joint content
- Submit speaking CFPs for upcoming conferences

Month 4 – Advanced Content + Certifications

- Publish 4 blogs on:
 - ✓ Azure Managed Instance
 - ✓ Hybrid networking for SQL workloads
 - ✓ Azure Data Factory pipelines
 - ✓ Elastic pools vs Hyperscale
- Launch a YouTube playlist: **"Praveen's Azure DBA Guide"**
- Earn/renew Azure certification (DP-300/DP-203/AZ-305 recommended)

Month 5 – Larger Community Impact

- Organize a mini virtual conference:
"Azure SQL Migration Week"
- Create hands-on labs on GitHub
- Publish a downloadable eBook:
"Azure SQL Migration Playbook – DBA Edition"
- Mentor 2–3 early-career DBAs

Month 6 – Consolidation & MVP Submission Prep

- Publish a flagship long-form article (5,000+ words):
"Azure SQL Migration: Architecture, Security, Performance, Automation"
- Present at 1 major community event
- Finalize your MVP contribution calendar
- Gather references from MVPs
- Prepare nomination form draft (included below)

Weekly Habits (High Impact)

- Post 3–4 short LinkedIn updates (tips/scripts/screenshots)
- Spend 1 hour reviewing Azure/SQL documentation updates
- Contribute at least 1 GitHub commit (scripts, docs, examples)
- Support community questions on:
StackOverflow, Microsoft Q&A, Reddit r/AZURE
- Draft 1 paragraph of long-form content
- Attend or watch 1 technical session

Specific Content Ideas (Custom-Fit for Your Focus Areas)

Azure SQL / SQL DBA

- Automating SQL Server migration assessment with DMA
- How to choose between Azure SQL DB, MI, and SQL VM
- Real-world comparison: **AWS RDS SQL vs Azure SQL MI**
- Query Store deep dive (Top 10 patterns)
- How to design HA/DR for mission-critical SQL workloads in Azure

Azure Data Engineering

- Using Data Factory for incremental SQL migrations
- Building end-to-end ELT using ADF + Azure SQL
- Purview integration for enterprise data governance
- Data Lake + Synapse architecture for DBAs

Azure Infrastructure

- VNets, private endpoints & networking for SQL workloads
- Automated backups and PITR strategies
- Hybrid AD authentication for Azure SQL
- Cost optimization techniques for Managed Instance

Community Activities (Personalized to Your Strengths)

- Conduct a “DBA to Cloud DBA” workshop
- Host monthly SQL troubleshooting clinics
- Write migration scripts and publish on GitHub
- Volunteer as a reviewer for open-source SQL tools
- Participate as a speaker for:
 - ✓ Data Platform Virtual Summit
 - ✓ SQLBits (CFP)
 - ✓ Azure Global Bootcamp
 - ✓ Local Microsoft Azure user groups (India)
- Mentor students/early DBAs through LinkedIn

2. Your MVP Nomination Draft

Professional MVP Nomination Paragraph (Microsoft Style)

Kumar is a highly active community-driven Database Administrator from India specializing in SQL Server, Azure SQL, and cloud migrations across Azure and AWS. He consistently contributes through technical articles, open-source scripts, speaking engagements, and hands-on guidance for data professionals transitioning to cloud-based architectures. With strong expertise in Azure SQL, Data Engineering, and Infrastructure, Praveen empowers the community by sharing real-world migration experiences, performance optimization techniques, and automation solutions. His contributions have helped hundreds of engineers adopt best practices for secure, optimized, and cost-effective data workloads in Azure. Praveen exemplifies the spirit of technical excellence, community leadership, and continuous knowledge sharing that the Microsoft MVP program recognizes.

Contributions Summary Table (Copy-Paste Ready)

Category	Contribution	Quantity	Links/Notes
Blogs / Articles	Azure SQL, Migrations, Performance	12+	GitHub/Medium/LinkedIn
YouTube Sessions	Azure SQL, ADF, Infra	10+	YouTube Playlist
Conference Talks	SQL/Azure Events	4+	Community UG links
Workshops	Cloud DBA, Azure SQL Migration	3+	Virtual/live
GitHub Contributions	Migration scripts, automation, labs	30+ commits	GitHub repo
Community Q&A	MS Q&A, StackOverflow	150+ answers	Profiles
Mentorship	Coaching junior DBAs	10+ mentees	Program notes
Toolkits	Azure Migration Script Pack	1	GitHub

Top 10 Showcase Links (Template)

Replace placeholders with your actual URLs.

1. Blog – Azure SQL Migration Guide
2. Blog – Query Store Deep Dive
3. GitHub – Azure SQL Migration Scripts Pack
4. GitHub – Automated Index Tuning Scripts
5. YouTube – Azure SQL Performance Series
6. YouTube – Cloud DBA Introduction
7. Speaking – Azure UG Session
8. Article – AWS vs Azure SQL for DBAs
9. Workshop – Azure SQL Hands-On Lab
10. LinkedIn – Weekly Tips Series Archive

★ Value You Bring to the Community

- A practical, hands-on perspective as a working DBA who has executed **real-world migrations**
- Strong cross-cloud understanding (Azure + AWS SQL)
- Ability to simplify complex concepts for new DBAs
- Contributions that improve productivity (scripts, automation, labs)
- Consistency in content across multiple platforms
- Focus on community growth and mentorship

✅ 3. Copy-Paste Google Sheet Checklist

Below is a **Google-Sheet-ready** structure.

Copy → Paste into Google Sheets → It auto-splits into columns.

Sheet 1: Monthly Metrics

Month, Blogs Published, Videos Created, Talks Delivered, GitHub Commits, Community Q&A Answers, Mentorship Hours, New Followers, Reach/Views

January,,,,,,,,

February,,,,,,,,

March,,,,,,,,

April,,,,,,,,

May,,,,,,,,

June,,,,,,,,

Sheet 2: Content Tracker

Date, Title, Type (Blog/Video/Talk), Status (Idea/Draft/Published), Platform, Target Audience, URL, Notes

,,,,,,

Sheet 3: Contribution Categories

Category, Description, Example, Status

Blog, Technical articles, Azure SQL tuning guide,

YouTube, Educational videos, Azure SQL playlist,

Open Source, Scripts + tooling, Migration automation scripts,

Speaking, User group talks, Azure SQL performance session,

Workshops, Hands-on events, Cloud DBA workshop,
Community Support, Q&A contributions, StackOverflow/MS Q&A,
Mentorship, Guiding juniors, 1:1 sessions,

Sheet 4: Weekly Checklist

Task, Weekly Target, Completed (Y/N), Notes
Post LinkedIn Content,4,,
Publish Blog or Draft,1,,
GitHub Commit,1,,
Answer Community Questions,5+,,
Learn New Azure Feature,1,,
Watch/Attend Technical Session,1,,

Sheet 5: MVP Evidence Log

Date, Category, Description, Link, Impact, Notes

,,,,,

Additional Reference links:

<https://www.mssqltips.com/sqlservertip/5138/how-to-become-a-sql-server-mvp/>

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XE4kmA0cji4> → **How To Become A Microsoft MVP**

<https://www.nigelfrank.com/insights/how-to-become-a-microsoft-mvp/>